

Homework #1

Vocabulary · Grammar · Writing · Speaking

Student Alev Elmas
Teacher Khan Ahsan Hussain
Based on Lesson 1 — 24 April 2026
Deadline 14 May 2026
Total Time ≈ 2 hours

A note for you, Alev:

This homework was built entirely from *your* first lesson. Every exercise uses words you encountered, mistakes you made, and topics from your real life. There are no generic exercises here — only things that are directly useful to you. Take your time, do one section per sitting if needed, and remember: making mistakes is how you improve. **Good luck!**

Contents & Time Guide

Section	Focus	Time
Section 1	Vocabulary Building	30 min
Section 2	Grammar Practice	40 min
Section 3	Writing Task	30 min
Section 4	Speaking Practice	20 min
Total		≈ 120 min

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Section

1 — Vocabulary Building

30 minutes

1Part A: Words from Your Lesson

Every word below appeared in your first lesson — either you searched for it, your teacher used it, or you needed it and could not find it. Learn them, and they will immediately make your speaking and writing more natural.

Word	Meaning
burden	a heavy responsibility or load that is difficult to carry
internship	a temporary work placement, usually for university students
proposal	a formal offer; e.g. a marriage proposal
graduation	the ceremony when students complete their university degree
workflow	the organised sequence of steps used to complete a task
Dean	the head of a faculty or department at a university
burnout	extreme mental and physical exhaustion caused by overwork
complaint	a statement expressing dissatisfaction or a problem
manuscript	a written research document, especially before publication
publishing	making written work available for others to read officially

Task 1A — Write Your Own Sentences

Write **one sentence for each word** below. Make each sentence **true about your real life or job**. The first one is done as an example for you.

Example — burden:

“Managing over 1,000 students is a great burden for a single department head.”

1. internship: _____

2. proposal: _____

3. graduation: _____

4. workflow: _____

5. Dean: _____

6. burnout: _____

7. complaint: _____

8. manuscript: _____

9. publishing: _____

1Part B: Phrasal Verbs for Daily Life

In your lesson you said: **"we can't touch each other"**

Your teacher corrected it to: **"we can't get in touch with each other"**

You learned it immediately — well done! Now learn five more phrasal verbs that are directly useful for your life.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
get in touch	to contact someone	<i>"I need to get in touch with the Dean."</i>
keep up with	to stay at the same level; not fall behind	<i>"It's hard to keep up with 50 emails a day."</i>
burn out	to become exhausted from overwork	<i>"If I don't rest, I will burn out."</i>
deal with	to handle a problem or situation	<i>"I have to deal with many complaints each week."</i>
catch up with	to talk with someone after time apart	<i>"I never have time to catch up with my friends."</i>

Task 1B — Fill in the Blank

Complete each sentence with the correct phrasal verb from the box above. Change the form if necessary.

1. I haven't spoken to my aunt in weeks. I really need to _____ with her.

2. There are so many emails every day. It is almost impossible to _____ them all.
3. She works sixteen hours a day. If she continues, she will _____ soon.
4. Could you please _____ the graduation paperwork before Friday?
5. Please _____ with me when you have a free moment — I need your advice.

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Section

2 — Grammar Practice

40 minutes

1Part A: Present Perfect vs. Simple Past

You said: "I didn't sleep well since March."**Correct:** "I **haven't slept** well since March."**The rule:**

- Use **Simple Past** for finished actions with a specific time:
"I went to the bank this morning."
- Use **Present Perfect** when the action started in the past and is still connected to *now* — especially with **since, for, already, yet, ever, never**:
"I haven't slept well since March."

Signal Word	Tense to Use
since / for	Present Perfect
already / yet	Present Perfect
ever / never	Present Perfect
yesterday / last week / in 2010	Simple Past

Task 2A — Choose the Correct Form

Write the correct verb form in the space provided.

1. I _____ (not sleep) well since the pollen season started.
2. She _____ (graduate) from university in 2010.
3. I _____ (not see) my friends for three months.
4. He _____ (ghost) me after our argument last week.
5. I _____ (work) at Nişantaşı University for four years now.
6. We _____ (drink) tea with the bank manager this morning.
7. I _____ (never / visit) England in my life.
8. She _____ (call) me exactly one hour ago.

Answer Key (check your work): 1. haven't slept 2. graduated 3. haven't seen
 4. ghosted
 5. have worked 6. drank 7. have never visited 8. called

1Part B: Third Person Singular -s

You said: "she **don't** know English" **and** "he **have** a son"

Correct: "She **doesn't** know English" **and** "He **has** a son"

The rule: With **he / she / it** in the present tense, always add **-s** or **-es** to the main verb. For negatives, use **doesn't**, never "don't".

Task 2B — Correct the Errors

Each sentence has one mistake. Rewrite the corrected sentence on the line below it.

1. "My mother don't know what day it is anymore."

2. "He have a very warm and sweet personality."

3. "She don't have time to help me with anything."

4. "The Dean always say the same things to me."

5. "My student have a lot of potential and motivation."

1Part C: Articles & Prepositions

These small words cause big problems — but they follow clear patterns!

You said		Correct
"go bank"	→	"go to the bank"
"I came to home "	→	"I came home " (no preposition)
"I have a one more problem"	→	"I have one more problem"
"responsibility about my family"	→	"responsibility for my family"
"I hope to conversation"	→	"I hope to have a conversation"

Task 2C — Fix the Mistake

Rewrite each sentence correctly on the line below it.

1. "I need to go bank and deal with a money issue for my family."

2. "After a long day, I came to home completely exhausted."

3. "I have a one more responsibility that I forgot to mention."

4. "I feel a heavy responsibility about my mother and three aunts."

5. "I hope to conversation with my aunt because today is her birthday."

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Section

3 — Writing Task

30 minutes

In your lesson, Khan asked you to write down your professional challenges so he can help you automate your workflow. This is **exactly** that task — and it is also your English writing practice. Two birds, one stone!

Task 3 — Write a Professional Summary Email

Context: Write a short professional email to your teacher, Khan, summarising your main work challenges. Write **150–200 words**.

Your email must include:

- ✓ A formal greeting
- ✓ At least **3 specific professional challenges** (e.g. emails, students, the Dean, internship paperwork, publishing pressure)
- ✓ At least **2 vocabulary words** from Section 1 (e.g. *burden, workflow, burnout, manuscript...*)
- ✓ At least **1 sentence using the Present Perfect** (e.g. “I have not had time to...” or “I haven’t been able to...”)
- ✓ A polite professional closing

Starter template — you may change or ignore this completely:

Dear Khan,

I hope you are well. Following our first lesson, I wanted to share some of my current professional challenges with you as we discussed...

First of all, ...

Another issue is that I have ...

Finally, ...

I look forward to our next lesson.

Kind regards,
Alev

Write your email here:

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Section

4 — Speaking Practice

20 minutes

Use your phone's **voice recorder** app. Do **not** read from notes. Speak naturally, just like in your lesson. You will make 3 short recordings. You may send Recording 1 and Recording 2 to Khan before your next lesson if you feel confident — it is great practice!

Recording 1 — “My Day Today” (5 minutes)

Describe your day today from the moment you woke up until now.

You must use:

- Simple past for finished things: “*I woke up, I had breakfast, I went to...*”
- Present perfect where relevant: “*I have already spoken to... / I haven't eaten yet...*”
- At least 6 sentences. Aim to speak for **3–5 minutes** without stopping.

Notes / key words to help you prepare:

Recording 2 — “My Biggest Work Challenge” (5 minutes)

Tell Khan about **one specific problem** you have at work right now.

Cover these four points:

1. What the problem is
2. Why it started
3. What you have already tried to do about it
4. What you hope will happen

You must use at least one of these words: *burden / burnout / workflow*

Notes / key words to help you prepare:

Recording 3 — Pronunciation Practice (10 minutes)

Your teacher noticed that you add an extra vowel sound at the end of **-ing** words, likely from Turkish phonological habit. This recording will help you correct it.

Step 1: Say each word **slowly** five times, then at **normal speed** five times.

Word	Breakdown	Word	Breakdown
thinking	think – ing	speaking	speak – ing
working	work – ing	publishing	pub – lish – ing
learning	learn – ing	sleeping	sleep – ing
going	go – ing		

Step 2: Record yourself saying this full sentence **twice**:

“I have been thinking about working on my speaking and publishing more.”

Step 3: Play back your recording. Listen carefully. Then record it **one final time**. Does the -ing sound clean and crisp, with no extra vowel at the end? If yes — excellent work!

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Final

Submission Checklist

Before you submit on **14 May 2026**, confirm you have completed everything:

- ☐ **Task 1A:** Written 9 original sentences using the vocabulary words
- ☐ **Task 1B:** Completed the phrasal verb fill-in-the-blank exercise
- ☐ **Task 2A:** Completed the Present Perfect vs. Simple Past exercise
- ☐ **Task 2B:** Corrected all 5 third-person singular sentences
- ☐ **Task 2C:** Corrected all 5 article & preposition sentences
- ☐ **Task 3:** Wrote the professional email (150–200 words)
- ☐ **Recording 1:** “My Day Today” voice recording (3–5 min)
- ☐ **Recording 2:** “My Biggest Work Challenge” voice recording
- ☐ **Recording 3:** Pronunciation practice recording
- ☐ **Bonus:** Sent Recordings 1 & 2 to Khan before the lesson

You can do this, Alev. One step at a time.

Teacher’s Feedback Space:

Overall Score: _____ / 100

Next Lesson: Monday _____ at 10:00 AM